

The Tiny Tormentor

KING NICHOLAS of Russia was a **tyrant**. His **subjects** were very unhappy but could do nothing about it. **Tales** of his **despotism** spread **far and wide** until they reached the ears of a **flea** who **resolved** to **teach** the king a **lesson**.

One night, when the king **lay down** to sleep, he felt a sharp **prick**.

"OWWWWW!" he **screamed**. "What's that?"

"A flea who wants to correct your behaviour," came the reply.

"I will correct your behaviour, you **miserable** insect!" **roared** the **furious** king.

He got out of bed and **shook** his bedclothes, but unknown to him, the flea was **nestled** in his beard. When he went back to bed, he was again bitten.

"You, who are no bigger than a **grain** of sand, **dare** to attack the **mightiest** king?" **yelled** Nicholas. "I'll teach you."

The flea didn't **bother** to reply but continued biting him.

Nicholas got up the next morning in a **terrible temper** as he **hadn't slept a wink**. On his orders, the servants **scrubbed** the entire palace clean. But they couldn't find the flea as she was **tucked** under Nicholas' coat collar.

When the king went to bed at night, he felt the familiar **stinging** bite.

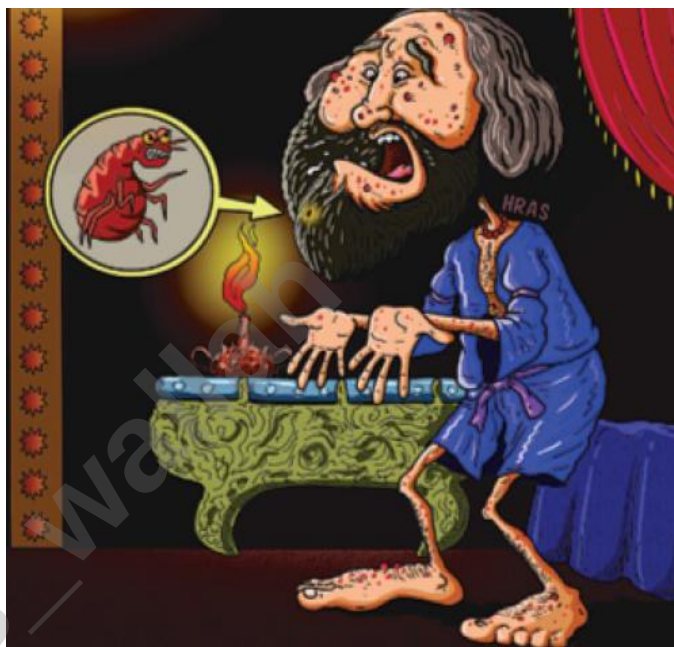
"You're still here?" he shouted. "What do you want?"

"Make your subjects happy," commanded the flea.

"Servants! Where are you?"

His servants rushed into the room. They **pulled** the bed **to pieces** and **tore up** the carpets. But they couldn't **trace** the flea as she was hidden in Nicholas' hair. He tried sleeping in another room but it was of no use.

The next day, Nicholas ordered his subjects to **exterminate** all fleas. But he continued to be harassed by the **irrepressible** creature for days. He became weak and **pale** with sleeplessness. His body was full



of **bruises** because of all the **blows** he had **administered** in an effort to crush his enemy. Finally, he **gave in**.

"Enough!" he cried one night. "I'll do whatever you tell me to do."

"Like I said, make your people happy," said the flea.

"How?"

"By leaving the kingdom."

The very next day, Nicholas announced that he was **abdicating** the **throne**. One of his ministers, a **wise** and respected man, was **crowned** the king. Nicholas then went away to a **neighbouring** kingdom and was never heard of again.

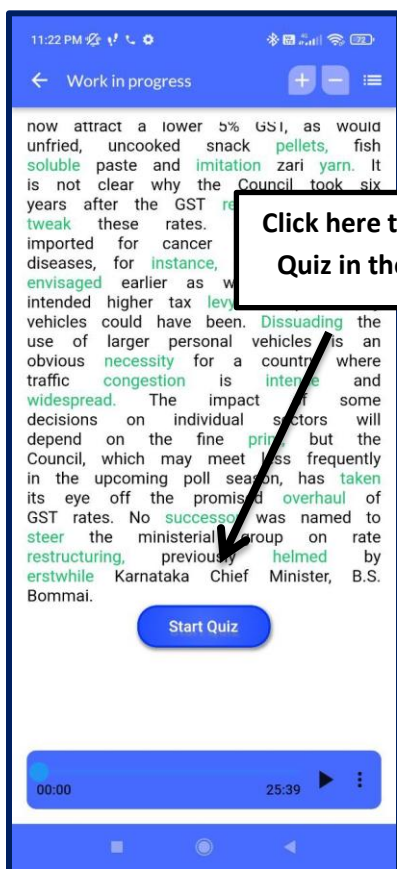
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Vocabulary

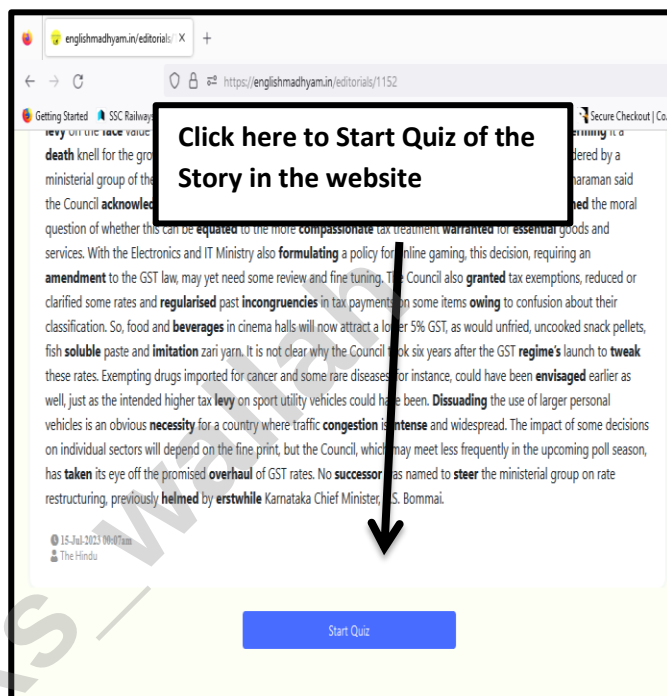
1. **Tormentor** (noun) – persecutor, oppressor, harasser, bully, nuisance यातना देने वाला
2. **Tyrant** (noun) – dictator, oppressor, autocrat, despot, authoritarian अत्याचारी शासक
3. **Subject** (noun) – citizen, inhabitant, denizen, resident, follower प्रजा
4. **Tale** (noun) – story, narrative, anecdote, fable, account कहानी
5. **Despotism** (noun) – tyranny, dictatorship, oppression, autocracy, absolutism निरंकुश शासन
6. **Far and wide** (phrase) – everywhere, all over, extensively, broadly, throughout दूर-दूर तक
7. **Flea** (noun) – parasite, bug, pest, insect, bloodsucker पिस्सू
8. **Resolve** (verb) – decide, determine, pledge, vow, undertake संकल्प करना
9. **Teach someone a lesson** (phrase) – punish, discipline, correct, reform, retaliate सबक सिखाना
10. **Lay down** (phrasal verb) – lie, recline, rest, stretch out, go to bed लेटना
11. **Prick** (noun) – sting, jab, puncture, pinch, poke चुभन
12. **Scream** (verb) – shout, yell, shriek, cry, wail चिल्लाना
13. **Miserable** (adjective) – unhappy, wretched, dejected, sorrowful, depressed दुःखी
14. **Roar** (verb) – shout, bellow, howl, thunder, yell दहाड़ना
15. **Furious** (adjective) – angry, enraged, livid, wrathful, incensed क्रोधित
16. **Shake** (verb) – jolt, rattle, tremble, wobble, agitate झाड़ना / हिलाना
17. **Nestle** (verb) – snuggle, hide, burrow, cuddle, tuck छिप जाना
18. **Grain** (noun) – particle, speck, bit, granule, kernel दाना
19. **Dare** (verb) – challenge, defy, venture, risk, confront साहस करना
20. **Mighty** (adjective) – powerful, strong, dominant, potent, formidable शक्तिशाली
21. **Yell** (verb) – scream, shout, bawl, cry out, call out चिल्लाना
22. **Bother** (verb) – trouble, annoy, disturb, irritate, hassle परेशान होना
23. **Terrible** (adjective) – awful, horrible, dreadful, appalling, miserable भयानक

24. **Temper** (noun) – mood, disposition, anger, rage, attitude क्रोध
25. **Not sleep a wink** (phrase) – stay awake, be sleepless, be restless, lie awake, remain alert एक पल भी न सोना
26. **Scrub** (verb) – clean, scour, wash, polish, rub जोर से साफ़ करना
27. **Tuck** (verb) – insert, hide, stuff, enclose, fold दबा देना
28. **Stinging** (adjective) – painful, burning, biting, sharp, prickly चुभने वाला
29. **Pull something to pieces** (phrase) – dismantle, destroy, break apart, tear down, rip to shreds टुकड़े-टुकड़े कर देना
30. **Tear up** (phrasal verb) – rip, shred, break, destroy, demolish फाड़ देना
31. **Trace** (verb) – track, find, detect, discover, follow पता लगाना
32. **Exterminate** (verb) – eliminate, destroy, wipe out, eradicate, kill नष्ट करना
33. **Irrepressible** (adjective) – uncontrollable, uncontainable, persistent, lively, untamed जिसे दबाया न जा सके
34. **Pale** (adjective) – wan, ashen, faint, colorless, light पीला / मुरझाया हुआ
35. **Bruise** (noun) – injury, contusion, black-and-blue mark, mark, damage नीला निशान
36. **Blow** (noun) – hit, strike, punch, knock, impact प्रहार
37. **Administer** (verb) – give, deliver, inflict, apply, carry out देना / लागू करना
38. **Give in** (phrasal verb) – surrender, yield, submit, relent, concede हार मान लेना
39. **Abdicate** (verb) – resign, renounce, relinquish, vacate, step down त्याग देना (सिंहासन)
40. **Throne** (noun) – royal seat, kingship, monarchy, crown, sovereignty सिंहासन
41. **Wise** (adjective) – intelligent, clever, sagacious, knowledgeable, prudent बुद्धिमान
42. **Crown** (verb) – coronate, anoint, install, enthrone, appoint राजा बनाना
43. **Neighbouring** (adjective) – adjacent, nearby, bordering, next to, surrounding पड़ोसी

Practice Exercise



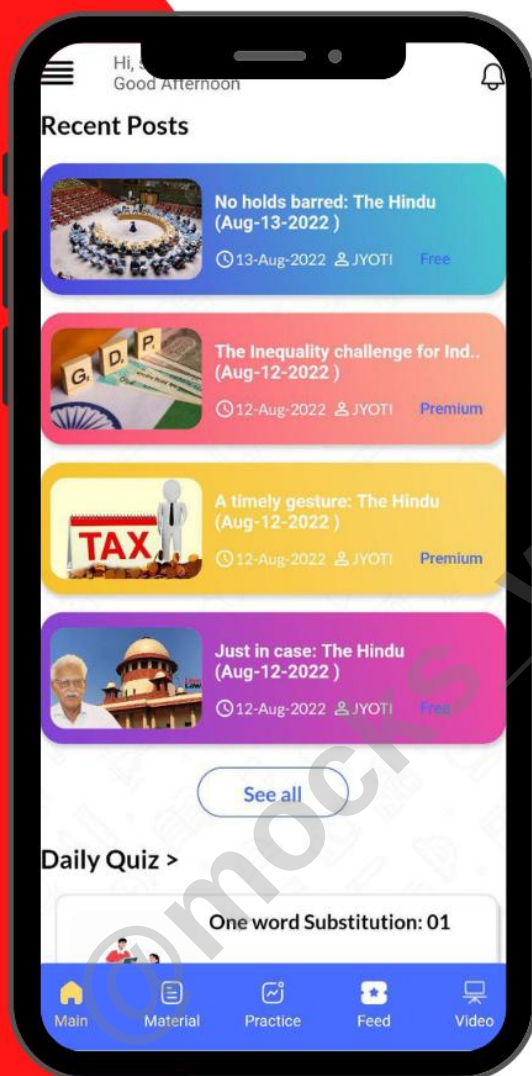
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